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Coordinates: 41°07′01″N 20°48′06″E

For other uses, see *Ohrid (disambiguation)*.
*"Achrida" redirects here. For other uses, see *Achrida (disambiguation)*.*

Ohrid (Macedonian: Охрид [ˈɔxɾit̪] [ⓘ]) is a city in North Macedonia and is the seat of the *Ohrid Municipality*. It is the largest city on *Lake Ohrid* and the eighth-largest city in the country, with it recording a population of over 38,000 inhabitants as of 2021. Ohrid is known for once having 365 churches,^[5] one for each day of the year, and has been referred to as the "Jerusalem of the Balkans".^{[2][6]} The city is rich in picturesque houses and monuments, and tourism is predominant. It is located southwest of *Skopje*, west of *Resen* and *Bitola*. In 1979 and in 1980, respectively, Ohrid and Lake Ohrid were accepted as Cultural and Natural *World Heritage Sites* by UNESCO. Ohrid is one of only 40 sites that are part of UNESCO's World Heritage that are Cultural as well as Natural sites.^[7]

Name [edit]

See also: *Names of European cities in different languages: M-P § O*



Ohrid by night. The ancient name of the city was *Lychnidos*, which probably means "city of light".

In antiquity the city was known under the ancient Greek name of *Λυχνίς* (*Lychnis*), *Λυχνιδός* or *Λύχνιδος* (*Lychnidos*) and the Latin *Lychnidus*,^{[8][9]} probably meaning "city of light", literally "a precious stone that emits light",^[10] from *λύχνος* (*lychnos*), "lamp, portable light".^[11] Polybius, writing in the second century BC, refers to the town as *Λυχνιδιον* - *Lychnidion*.^[12]

The evolution of the ancient toponym *Lychnidus* into *Oh(e)r(id)* required a long-

standing period of *Tosk Albanian*–*Eastern South Slavic* bilingualism, or at least contact, resulting from the *Tosk Albanian* *rotacism* *-n-* into *-r-* and Eastern South Slavic *l-vocalization* *ly-* into *o-*.^{[13][14][15]}

It became capital of the *First Bulgarian Empire* in the early medieval period, and was often referred to by *Byzantine* writers as *Achrida* (Ἀχρίδα, Ὀχρίδα, or Ἀχρίς).^{[16][8]} By 879 AD, the town was no longer called *Lychnidos* but was referred to as *Ohrid*.^{[17][18][19]}

In *Macedonian* and the other *South Slavic languages*, the name of the city is *Ohrid* (Охрид). In *Albanian*, the city is known as *Ohër* or *Ohri* and in modern Greek *Ochrida* (Οχρίδα, Οχρίδα) and *Achrida* (Αχρίδα).^[citation needed] The name of the city in *Aromanian* is *Ohârda*.^[20]

History [edit]

Historical affiliations

Illyrians (Enchele Dassareti) 8th century BC–5th century BC

Antiquity [edit]

The earliest inhabitants of the wider Lake Ohrid region were the *Illyrian*

Ohrid
Охрид (Macedonian)



Ohrid and Lake Ohrid



Flag



Coat of arms

Nicknames:
Balkan Jerusalem^[1]
Macedonian Jerusalem^[2]
European Jerusalem^[3]



Location within North Macedonia

Coordinates: 41°07′01″N 20°48′06″E

Country North Macedonia
Region Southwestern
Municipality Ohrid

Government